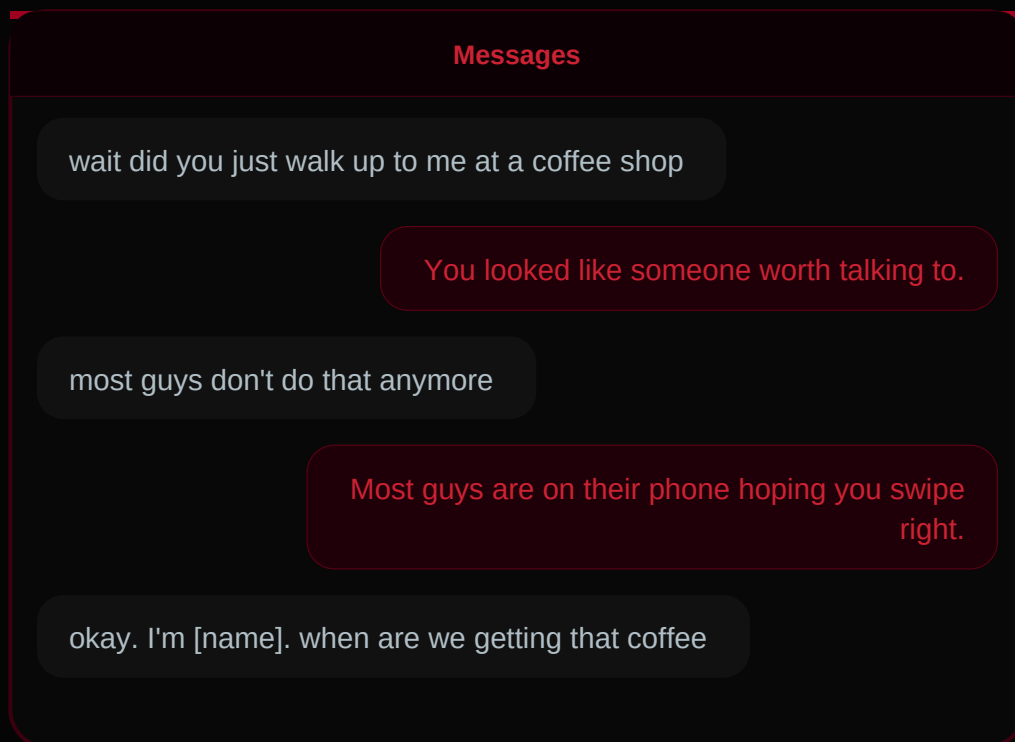
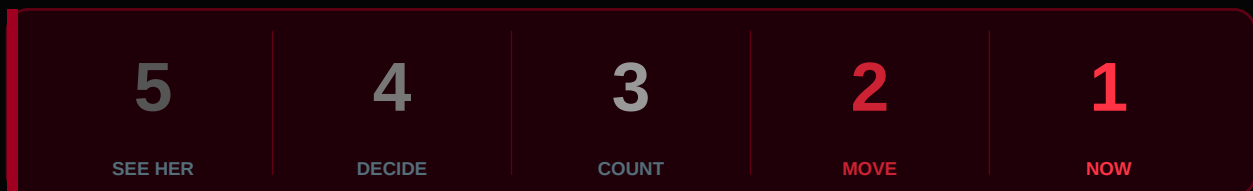


THE SHORT KING SERIES

BOOK FIVE

Approach Like a King

The Short Man's Real-World Program for Killing Approach Anxiety Forever



The Step-by-Step System That Turns Approaching Into a Skill, Not a Gamble.

The Short King Coaching

WHO THIS IS FOR

"Every man who dates has a woman he didn't approach. This book makes sure you stop adding to that list."

This book is for the man who freezes. The one who sees her across the bar, the coffee shop, the street, and spends sixty seconds running an internal negotiation that ends with him not moving. The one who gets home, opens a dating app, and thinks about the girl he didn't talk to.

Approach anxiety is the single biggest gap between the dating life a shorter man could have and the one he actually has. Not height. Not looks. Not money. **The willingness to close the distance between where he's standing and where she is.** This book is the system that closes that gap permanently.

How This Book Connects

Book Three built the internal confidence. Book Four built the presence. This book is where both go to work in a real approach. If you're coming to this book cold, it still works on its own — but everything compounds faster when the internal and presence work is already in place. For the text game after you get the number, go back to Book One. For first date execution, Book Two has you covered.

INTRODUCTION

The Approach Is the Whole Game

Every dating strategy in this series assumes one thing: that you actually talked to her first. And for a large percentage of men, that assumption is the problem.

Apps help. But apps filter aggressively for height. They remove context, personality, voice, and presence from the equation and replace them with a photograph and a number. **The man who can approach in person bypasses all of those filters and puts himself in front of the woman directly** — where everything he's built in this series can actually be felt.

For shorter men specifically, the in-person approach is where the playing field levels most dramatically. Presence, voice, humor, warmth, directness — all of these come through in an approach in ways they simply cannot in a profile. I've watched 5'5" men approach and close conversations that no dating app algorithm would have predicted as possible. The approach is where the Short King wins.

"Approach anxiety isn't a personality trait. It's a habit. And like every habit, it can be replaced with a better one through consistent, deliberate repetition."

CHAPTER ONE

Why Your Brain Fights You

The Neuroscience of the Freeze and How to Override It

You see her. A signal fires. Your chest tightens slightly. Your mind starts running calculations at speed: what if she's with someone? What if I say the wrong thing? What if she's not interested and everyone sees it? By the time that loop has run twice you've already decided it's not the right moment — and the moment has passed.

This is not weakness. This is your amygdala doing exactly what it was built to do: detecting social threat and generating an avoidance response. In evolutionary terms, approaching an unknown person you're attracted to and whose rejection carries social stakes genuinely resembles a threat scenario. The brain doesn't distinguish between physical danger and social danger with any sophistication. It just fires the response.

The problem is that habituation — the process by which repeated exposure degrades a threat response — requires you to actually approach. Every time you don't approach, the amygdala records: *threat avoided, response reinforced*. Every time you do approach, it records: *threat engaged, outcome survivable, threat level lower*.

The Override Mechanism

Mel Robbins documented this mechanism in her work on the five-second rule: the prefrontal cortex has approximately a five-second window to override an avoidance instinct before the amygdala locks the decision. After five seconds of not moving, the brain categorizes the situation as decided and the window closes.

The solution is not to eliminate the anxiety response. The solution is to act before the five-second window closes — every single time, without exception, regardless of how the anxiety feels. The action precedes the comfort. The comfort follows the action. Men who wait until they feel comfortable to approach never approach.



THE FIVE-SECOND TRIGGER

You notice her and decide to approach.

Count internally: **5 — 4 — 3 — 2 — 1**

On 1 you move. **Not after 1. On 1.**

The counting is a pattern interrupt — it occupies the prefrontal cortex so the amygdala cannot complete its avoidance loop before your feet are already moving.

Once your feet are moving the anxiety drops sharply. The anticipation is almost always worse than the approach.

◆ CASE STUDY: REAL CASE: THE FIRST APPROACH

A client at 5'6" described his approach pattern as perfect in his head and nonexistent in real life. He could visualize exactly what he would say. He had never actually done it. We introduced one rule only for the first week: no analysis, no preparation, no waiting for the right moment. See her, count to five, move. His first approach on day two lasted eleven seconds before she indicated she was waiting for someone. He described the walk back as the best he'd felt in months. Not because it went well — because the thing he'd been afraid of for years took eleven seconds and left him completely fine. By day seven he had approached six women. By the end of the month he had two numbers and one date. The anxiety didn't disappear. It just stopped being in charge.

■ YOUR MOVE

Commit to the five-second rule for the next seven days. Every time you notice an attractive woman in a real-world environment and feel the pull to approach, count 5-4-3-2-1 and move. Do not negotiate with the anxiety. Do not wait for the perfect opener. Move first and let the words come after. Log every approach: location, what you said, what happened.

CHAPTER TWO

What to Say in the First Five Seconds

Openers That Work in the Real World

Most men overthink the opener to the point where it becomes the reason they don't approach. They need the perfect line before they'll move — and since the perfect line never arrives, neither do they.

Here is the truth about openers: **the content matters far less than the delivery**. Tone, energy, and confidence account for the overwhelming majority of how an opener lands. The words themselves are almost secondary. A mediocre line delivered with warmth and ease outperforms a clever line delivered with visible nervousness every single time.

The opener's job is not to impress her. Its job is to open the interaction with enough energy and specificity that a conversation can begin. That's it. Once the conversation has begun, everything else in this series takes over.

The Three Opener Types

DIRECT — Highest risk, highest reward

You tell her directly you found her attractive and wanted to meet her. Completely honest, signals the kind of confidence most men never demonstrate. Best for street or daytime approaches with natural time pressure.

"I saw you from over there and thought I'd regret it if I didn't come say hello."

"You looked interesting. I'm [name]."

"This is slightly out of nowhere — but I thought you were attractive and I didn't want to just walk past."

SITUATIONAL — Most natural feeling

Use something real from the immediate environment as the entry point. Not contrived — something actually happening around you both. Anchors the conversation in shared reality rather than creating a moment that feels designed.

"I genuinely cannot tell if this song is supposed to be ironic or they just have terrible taste. [bar]"

"What are you working on? You look like you're either solving something important or very deep into a group chat. [coffee shop]"

"Is this your first time here or do you actually know which of these things are worth buying? [market]"

OPINION — Lowers the guard, opens the door

Ask for her opinion on something specific and low-stakes. Gives her an easy conversational entry point that doesn't require her to evaluate whether you're hitting on her. Lowers the social guard long enough for the actual interaction to begin.

"Quick question: if you had to pick one city to live in for the rest of your life that you've never lived in before, what would it be?"

"Honest opinion: is it weird to come to this kind of place alone or is that actually the move?"

"You look like you have an actual opinion about coffee. What's the order here worth getting?"

The Delivery Fundamentals

DELIVERY FUNDAMENTALS — EVERY APPROACH

EYE CONTACT Establish it before you speak. Look at her, not at your feet or the middle distance.

THE PAUSE One beat of silence after she registers your presence. That half-second communicates ease.

THE SMILE Smile with your eyes, not just your mouth. The difference is visible and she will know.

INFLECTION End the opener on a downward inflection. Statements, not questions where possible. Confidence reads as declarative.

◆ **CASE STUDY: COMPOSITE — STATE IS THE VARIABLE**

Three clients, same week, all working on openers. The first rehearsed a clever situational line for 20 minutes before approaching. He delivered it flawlessly and got a flat response. The second used a direct opener he'd never tried before, stumbled slightly on the words, and laughed at himself about it. She laughed too. They talked for eight minutes. The third used an opinion opener with zero preparation and ended up in a 12-minute conversation that ended with her asking for his number. The second and third had worse lines and better outcomes because their energy was warm and unguarded rather than practiced and tense. Content is not the variable. State is the variable.

■ **YOUR
MOVE**

Pick one opener type that fits your natural style. In your next five approaches, use the five-second rule to move and let whichever opener comes out naturally be the one you use. Evaluate delivery and energy afterward — not the words.

CHAPTER THREE

Running the Conversation

From Opener to Number Close

The opener gets you in the door. What you do in the next three to five minutes determines whether she gives you her number, whether she wants to keep talking, or whether the conversation politely ends and you both go back to your lives.

The goal is not to keep her talking. The goal is to build a specific emotional experience in a short window of time. The three-part approach conversation mirrors the date conversation structure from Book Two, compressed into a five-minute interaction: a warm and slightly playful opening exchange, one moment of genuine connection or interesting tension, and a confident close.

WARM EXCHANGE (first 60 seconds)

Light, easy, fun. You're not building rapport yet — you're lowering the social guard enough that she stops evaluating whether this is an approach and starts actually talking to you. No job questions. Ask something unexpected that requires her to actually think.

CONNECTION MOMENT (the middle)

A shift in energy — her responses get longer, she holds eye contact a beat more, she leans in slightly. Created by one of two things: something that genuinely surprised her, or something that made her feel seen rather than interviewed. Strong opinion or specific observation.

THE CLOSE (natural next step)

Not a separate event from the conversation. The natural continuation of something already working. Lead with a plan, not a question. Don't say 'can I get your number?' Say 'let's continue this' and take out your phone.

Connection Builders

CONNECTION BUILDERS IN THE APPROACH

UNEXPECTED OPINION

"Honestly I think [specific opinion]. Most people disagree but I've never been moved by the majority view."

SPECIFIC OBSERVATION

"You said [thing she mentioned] which is interesting because most people in [context] think the opposite. What's that about?"

THE GENUINE QUESTION

"What's the thing you're actually working toward right now? Not the answer you'd give your parents. The real one."

Close Scripts

CLOSE SCRIPTS

STANDARD

"This has been the best conversation I've had today. Let's continue it." [take out phone and hand it to her]

WITH PLAN

"I'm grabbing food at [place] on Saturday. You should come. Put your number in."

SOFT CLOSE

*"I'll let you get back to it. But I'd like to continue this." [pause, eye contact, slight smile]
"What's your number?"*

After she gives you her number: don't look down at your phone. Look at her. Say something brief and warm. Then leave. The man who gets the number and exits clean is more attractive than the man who keeps talking until the moment deflates.

◆ CASE STUDY: REAL CASE: THE CLEAN EXIT

A client had been getting phone numbers from approaches but converting zero to dates. We looked at his close behavior and found the problem immediately: he was getting the number and then continuing to talk for another five to eight minutes, recapping things they'd already discussed and making plans that felt premature. By the time he left, the energy he'd built had been talked back to neutral. We introduced one rule: get the number and leave within 60 seconds. On his next three approaches he closed and exited clean. Two of the three numbers converted to dates. Same man. Same approach. The exit was the only change.

■ YOUR
MOVE

On your next approach, after the number is in your phone: look at her, say something brief and warm, and leave within 60 seconds. No recapping. No over-planning. Get the number and get out while the energy is still high.

Approaching as a Shorter Man

The Specific Adjustments That Change Everything

Most approach advice is written for men of average height or taller. The fundamentals apply across the board, but there are specific adjustments that shorter men can make that significantly improve their conversion rates.

The core principle: in an in-person approach, you are not a number on a dating app profile. You are a human being with energy, voice, humor, and presence — all of which she is experiencing simultaneously and none of which can be captured in a height measurement. **The approach is where the playing field levels. Your job is to make the most of what levels it.**

The Positioning Advantage

A direct face-to-face approach, where you're standing directly in front of her at close range, makes height differential most visible and creates a slightly confrontational energy regardless of tone.

✗ FACE-TO-FA CE

Maximizes height visibility. Creates slightly confrontational energy. The default that most men use.

✓ SIDE APPROACH

Coming in from a slight angle — beside her rather than blocking her path. Creates an energy of joining rather than intercepting. Naturally shorter social distance at any height.

✓ MOVE TO SEATED

If conversation develops past two minutes: suggest moving to a bar, seating area, or outside. Seated conversation neutralizes height entirely and creates natural intimacy standing conversations have to work harder to achieve.

The Height Mention in the Approach

Occasionally she will mention your height during or just after an approach. This is a frame test — exactly as covered in Book Four — and it requires the same calm composure. The worst responses are defensiveness and explanation. Both confirm the topic has power over you.

HEIGHT MENTION RESPONSES

HER: "I usually date taller guys, just so you know."

***YOU:** "Noted. I usually date women who are less predictable. Seems like we both have things to work through." [smile, continue]*

HER: "How tall are you?"

***YOU:** "Tall enough to have this conversation." [smile] — OR simply state your height with no apology and continue talking.*

SOMEONE ELSE MAKES A COMMENT:

***YOU:** [brief glance at them, slight smile, back to her] — Don't address it. Returning attention to her is the power move.*

Daytime vs Nighttime Approaches

DAYTIME

Harder to initiate, easier to run. More neutral social context, lower implied stakes. Conversation tends to be more natural. For men building approach muscle from scratch, daytime is where to start.

NIGHTTIME

Higher ambient energy — can work in your favor. People more open to meeting strangers. The vocal variables from Book Four shine in high-stimulus environments. In this context the goal is often just the number rather than a full conversation.

◆ CASE STUDY: COMPOSITE — ENVIRONMENT IS THE VARIABLE

A client at 5'4" had been approaching exclusively in bars for six months with low conversion rates. He was convinced the problem was his height. We shifted his approach practice to daytime environments for one month: coffee shops, bookstores, parks, farmers markets. Within two weeks his conversion rate tripled. The reason: in daytime contexts his personality, humor, and directness had space to land. In the bar context the noise was filtering out everything that made him compelling and leaving only the visual impression. He added nighttime approaches back in month two with the vocal work from Book Four installed — and his bar conversion rate improved significantly as well. The environment was the variable, not his height.

■ YOUR
MOVE

This week, run at least two approaches in daytime environments you don't normally approach in. A coffee shop, a bookstore, a park. Use the side approach positioning rather than direct face-to-face. Write down one thing that worked better than expected.

CHAPTER FIVE

The 30-Day Approach Program

Building the Habit That Changes Everything

Approach anxiety is a habit. Approaching is a habit. Both are built through repetition and both decay without it. The 30-day program below is designed to install approaching as a default behavior — not an occasional heroic act.

The program works in weekly phases, each building on the previous one. The early weeks prioritize volume over quality — getting your nervous system accustomed to the approach interaction regardless of outcome. The later weeks add conversation quality and close targets. By day 30, you are not trying to overcome anxiety in the moment. You are doing what has become normal.

WEEK ONE

5 approaches. Volume only. Five-second rule every time.

→ Days 1–2: One approach each day in a low-pressure environment. Opener plus one exchange is sufficient.

→ Days 3–5: One approach per day, any environment. Begin noting which opener type feels most natural.

→ Days 6–7: Two approaches in a single outing, back to back if possible. Proves the anxiety from one approach doesn't carry into the next.

KEY: Success metric: you moved within five seconds. Outcomes are irrelevant.

WEEK TWO

5 approaches. Each must last at least two minutes.

→ Add one unexpected question or opinion to every conversation.

→ Practice the clean exit from every approach regardless of how it goes.

→ At least two of this week's five approaches in non-bar (daytime) environments.

KEY: Success metric: a genuine two-minute conversation that ends naturally.

WEEK THREE

5 approaches. Attempt the close every time.

→ Use the assumptive close every time — state it as a natural next step, not a question.

→ Practice the 60-second exit after every number. Get it and leave before energy deflates.

→ Log all close attempts and outcomes. See that the ratio is predictable and manageable.

KEY: Success metric: you attempted the close, not whether it converted.

WEEK FOUR

5 approaches. Full system integrated.

→ Five-second rule, positioning, opener, warm exchange, connection moment, close, clean exit.

→ Run at least one nighttime approach. Apply the vocal work in a high-noise environment.

→ Run at least one approach in a new environment you haven't approached in before.

KEY: Review your four-week log. Identify your highest-conversion opener type and main sticking point.

APPROACH LOG FORMAT

Date: [date] | **Environment:** coffee shop / bar / street / other

Opener used: direct / situational / opinion | **Duration:** seconds / minutes

Connection moment: yes / no | **Close attempted:** yes / no | **Outcome:** number / conversation / polite end

One thing that worked: [write it]

One adjustment for next time: [write it]

◆ CASE STUDY: REAL CASE: THE FULL 30 DAYS

A client completed the full 30-day program while keeping a detailed log. Week 1: five approaches, average duration 45 seconds, zero closes attempted, significant anxiety on every approach. Week 2: five approaches, average duration 3 minutes, one close attempted, anxiety described as present but manageable. Week 3: five approaches, average duration 4 minutes, four closes attempted, two numbers. Week 4: five approaches including two nighttime, average duration 5 minutes, four closes attempted, three numbers, one date set. At the end he said: 'I spent two years not approaching because I was convinced my height made it pointless. Thirty days of actually doing it taught me more about dating than two years of thinking about it. The anxiety is still there. It's just not running anything anymore.'

■ YOUR MOVE

Start the 30-day program today. Not Monday. Not next week. Today. Your first approach of week one happens within 24 hours of reading this page. Set up your approach log in your phone right now. The log is not optional — it is the difference between a feeling of vague progress and actual data showing your development over 30 days.

Quick Reference

Screenshot this. Review it before every approach session.

THE FIVE-SECOND RULE

- See her. Decide. Count 5-4-3-2-1. Move on 1.
- No negotiation. No waiting for perfect. Movement is the only requirement.
- The anticipation is always worse than the approach.

THREE OPENER TYPES

- **Direct:** Honest, high-confidence. Tell her you noticed her.
- **Situational:** Something real in the environment. Most natural.
- **Opinion:** Low-stakes question. Lowers the guard.

DELIVERY FUNDAMENTALS

- Eye contact before you speak
- One beat of silence before the opener
- Genuine smile — eyes, not just mouth
- Downward inflection on statements

CONVERSATION STRUCTURE

- **Warm exchange:** Light and playful. No job questions.
- **Connection moment:** One unexpected opinion or specific observation.
- **Close:** Assumptive. Lead with plan. Exit within 60 seconds of number.

THE 30-DAY TARGETS

- 1 Week 1: Five approaches. Volume only. Five-second rule.
- 2 Week 2: Five approaches. Two minutes minimum. Add connection.
- 3 Week 3: Five approaches. Attempt the close every time.
- 4 Week 4: Full system. Include nighttime and new environments.

SHORT KING ADJUSTMENTS

- Side approach — beside her, not blocking her path.
- Move to seated if conversation goes past two minutes.
- Height mention = frame test. Calm, slight smile, continue.
- Start with daytime approaches. Easier to run, faster to build.

The approach is handled. Now make every conversation after it count.

You can approach now. You can move within five seconds, open with confidence, run the conversation, and close it. That is a complete skill set that most men never build.

The next layer is what happens inside the conversation itself — specifically the ability to create attraction through the way you talk, not just the fact that you're talking. Most men can hold a conversation. Very few can hold one that makes a woman feel something. That difference is what Book Six is built around.

The Attraction Conversation: How to Make Her Feel Something Every Time You Talk

Book Six in the Short King Series

- How to tease in a way that creates chemistry rather than awkwardness
 - Qualification techniques so she invests in the interaction
 - Building tension through storytelling
 - Deep rapport that makes her want to keep this going long after it ends
-



"Stop waiting for the right moment. The right moment is the one where you move."

THE SHORT KING COMPLETE SYSTEM

Seven books covering every dimension of the dating game for shorter men: texting, first dates, confidence, presence, approach, attraction conversations, and dating profiles. Each works as a standalone. Together they are the complete system.

Want direct coaching?

Coaching puts someone in your corner for the real interactions: reviewing your approach logs, identifying your specific sticking points, and accelerating your results with direct feedback on your field work. Reach out through the Short King Coaching platform.



Five seconds. That's all that separates the man you are from the man you could be.